

**Regular Meeting
Monday, January 6, 2020
Medford School Committee
Medford City Hall**

Present: Ms. Graham, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. McLaughlin, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Lungo-Koehn, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, Student Representatives Marc Allen Jean-Mary and Isabella DeSouza.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:33pm.

Approval of the Minutes of December 16, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report of Committees - Organizational Meeting and Caucus - Ms. Mustone nominated Paul Ruseau for Vice Chair. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Mr. Ruseau will be the Vice Chair for 2020.

Ms. Kreatz nominated Paulette Van der Kloot for Secretary. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Ms. Van der Kloot will be the Secretary for 2020.

Committee of the Whole - Executive Session - Discussion of pending litigation.

Motion to request from our attorney an estimate of potential costs of attorney fees for both sides; an assessment of probable success; and what kind of negotiations could occur within their amicable settlement offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Motion to request that student orientation and eligibility policies and procedures in place in Medford Public Schools be provided to the School Committee by March 23, 2020 offered by Ms. Graham, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Community Participation - Joey Falco - 123 Fulton Spring Road - I am a student at the high school. Thank you for your service and good luck in your upcoming term. I am here to discuss the high school bathrooms. I have started a change.org petition signed by nearly 450 people. The bathrooms are in bad shape and I have photographic evidence to share. Some issues may cost money to fix, but some issues may be able to be fixed immediately and I request your help in fixing the issues.

Ms. Van der Kloot requested that we take item 3 out of order to address the Community Participation item.

Report on MPS Bathrooms - John McLaughlin - The bathrooms are old. I encourage people to report rodents or pests because we have an integrated pest management system and we can take care of it right away. Mr. Ruseau - I have a question about how students and staff can quickly report incidents. Mr. McLaughlin - They can go through Assistant Principals or Headmaster D'Alleva. We get reports through the Assistant Principals over the radio and we send somebody right up. Mr. Ruseau - How often are custodians checking in throughout the day? Mr. D'Alleva - We clean, shut down, and reopen twice a day. That is more than we were doing before. The frequency helps us with reporting. Ms. Kreatz - Did you notice any black mold? Particles in the soap dispenser? Mr. McLaughlin - I have not noticed any of that. We have replaced six soap dispensers. Ms. Kreatz - Can we add something to the website? Mr. McLaughlin - We are working on rolling out the See Something Say Something app, which will help. The Buildings and Grounds door is always open.

Dr. Cushing - We received Free Cash to completely renovate two bathrooms in the high school down to the studs. We hope the bathrooms will become a source of pride and a source of respect.

Ms. Graham - When will See Something Say Something be ready? Mr. McLaughlin - I believe we are in the queue for it, but we were not up next, so we got put onto a waiting list. It is a free app, and when it becomes available we said we would take it up, but I do not know the timeline.

It would not be only for Buildings and Grounds issues. Ms. Graham - Can we get an update on the timeline at our next meeting?

Ms. Van der Kloot - I would like to remind the committee that we put together a five year plan for updates and the bathrooms were part of that. We had anticipated there would be certain monies available. We may need to revisit it. There is the short term immediacy, but there is also the larger issue of the MHS Vision Committee. Ms. Mustone - I think we should heavily prioritize this. Can we think creatively about doing more than two bathrooms? Mr. McLaughlin - The more the merrier. We may need to move students if we do many bathrooms at once, like when we did the science labs.

Ms. Kreatz - What is the status of the MHS Vision Committee? Mayor Lungo-Koehn - The Superintendent and I will review the applications next week.

Motion by Ms. McLaughlin, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to find out in the next 30 days to find out which two bathrooms will be renovated.

Motion by Ms. Graham to follow up on the See Something Say Something app by the next meeting.

Motion by Ms. Mustone to look into renovating an additional two bathrooms.

Motion by Ms. Graham to revisit the Capital Plan in a Committee of the Whole meeting.

Motion to accept offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Rochelle Patterson - 146 Fern Road - I would like to reiterate the importance of the bathroom issue. I hear from my daughters frequently that they do not go to the bathroom throughout the day at the high school. They are afraid to drink water because they will have to use the bathroom. Please address this issue in a timely manner.

Kristy Avino and Bailey Schendell - Citywide Elementary Alliance Disney Raffle Drawing - Thanks to Superintendent Edouard-Vincent, Mayor Burke, Allie Fiske, Deanna Deveney, Adam Hurtubise, Principal Johnson, Principal Guarino, Principal Kay, and Principal Galusi. Jim Granara, Jr. from Stoneham, MA is the first prize winner. The second prize winner is Quadasha Petit.

Motion to receive and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell - Welcome to our new School Committee members and our new Mayor, Mayor Lungo-Koehn. I want to make you aware of one sad report, a letter that was sent to us by the Norwell ice hockey team. A parent of the Norwell ice hockey team that the Medford team was competing against unfortunately passed away during a game. Our team attended the funeral and a parent sent a letter of appreciation for the show of support. Youth sports is about teaching our kids so much more than how to play a game.

Recognition of Max Stephens for Winning a Gold Medal in Ice Hockey in the Deaflympics - Ms. Caldwell - Medford High School senior Max Stephens traveled to Italy to represent the United States as part of the USA National Deaf Ice Hockey Team at the 2019 Winter Deaflympics. Congratulations.

Report on Fiscal Year 2019 Closeout - Kirsteen Patterson - The word appropriation refers to the budget that is allocated by the city. According to MGL requirements we are unable to present a budget in deficit so we recover those numbers using revolving funds such as Athletics, Pool, Rink, and Community Schools.

Mr. Ruseau - The technology expenditure was high. Do you expect it to be high next year? Ms. Patterson - It was a bubble year. Some line items are higher, some are lower, we land on the bottom line. Ms. McLaughlin - We are over expectations on substitutes. Ms. Patterson - Yes, that is long-standing substitutes. We also have challenges getting substitutes for daily coverage. It is a difficult position to fill, and not just in Medford. We pay \$90 as a daily rate. Ms. Graham - How does our substitute rate compare to other municipalities? Ms. Patterson - \$90 is a competitive rate locally. Mr. Ruseau - The Kindergarten aides listed here, how many people does that cover? Ms. Patterson - In fiscal year 19 the Kindergarten aides were all different but this year they joined a collective bargaining unit and became full time so it will be more consistent going forward. Mr. Ruseau - Under special education there are many teacher salaries budgeted for zero dollars. Ms. Patterson - Yes, we offset these programs in other areas in order to have a balanced budget. We have to show special education teachers in each building. Mr. Ruseau - This is an important story to tell the people of Medford. When they suggest we should not rent out the high school, you would not suggest that we not have special education teachers at the McGlynn, and that is how we offset those teacher salaries. Ms. McLaughlin - Why are special education costs not included in the budget? Ms. Patterson - If we included the amounts the budget would be too high for the budget allocation and it needs to be balanced. It is not shown as a budget item, but it is shown to accurately report that our funding is going to special education services at each location. Ms. McLaughlin - How is it shown every year? Ms. Patterson - We have to backfill it with other revenue sources. I think going over the budget process will be beneficial. Mr. Ruseau

- The adjustment counselors is the same situation as special education teachers? Ms. Patterson - Yes. Mr. Ruseau - Are some psychologists part time? Ms. Patterson - They are paid based on their years of experience. They are all full time. Mr. Ruseau - The out of district special education tuition seems less than I expected. Ms. Patterson - That area is funded from multiple sources. We have circuit breaker from the state, IDEA federal grant, so our tuition is more in the range of \$3.4 million. Mr. Ruseau - Does anyone give us anything for pupil transportation? Ms. Patterson - No, that is tuition only. Ms. Graham - For adjustment counselors, were there the same number at each of the schools? Ms. Patterson - I believe there was one at each school, but the pay scale may have been different. Mr. Ruseau - Under social studies there are funds for social studies field trips, \$4,000, what does that cover? Ms. Patterson - Bus costs. Ms. Graham - That is not much. Ms. Patterson - This is just one program area. Ms. Graham - Can you provide a description of field trips? Ms. Patterson - It varies each year. We would have to look at it going forward. Everything is approved by the School Committee. We do not keep a running list for the budgets. Mr. Ruseau - What does CW refer to under art/music teacher? Ms. Patterson - That is district-wide, covering various buildings. Mr. Ruseau - Under physical education/health, salaries/wages permanent is much smaller. Did somebody leave? Ms. Patterson - That is under the supervisory category. It was a combination of two, I can provide you the breakout. Mr. Ruseau - I noticed the Columbus and Roberts, did the teachers move from one school to the next? Ms. Patterson - Yes, sometimes there is shifting from one department to the next, where we anticipated costs may not be where they landed. Mr. Ruseau - Did we hire a nurse for \$50,000? Ms. Patterson - Yes, sometimes there are unanticipated one-to-one nurses required. Mr. Ruseau - Stipends? Ms. Patterson - Yes, if the nurse has to attend special events with the student. Mr. Ruseau - Athletics is over budget. Ms. Patterson - Athletics has historically been in a deficit. We do not know if our teams will make it into the finals, which means we will encounter extra fees, for officials, travel, trophies, etc. Ms. McLaughlin - Is this a public report that is shared? Ms. Patterson - This is provided to the School Committee. It is not posted online. It is public record, but it is not distributed. Mr. Ruseau - What are contracted security services? Ms. Patterson - Camera replacement and things of that nature. Ms. Van der Kloot - Do you have numbers of how much money from the programs that generate money are used to offset other programs? Ms. Patterson - We had identified \$1 million for the Before and After School programs, but we ended up with \$500,000. MEEP was \$150,000. The others I do not know offhand. Community Schools and building rentals basically maintain the costs of the rentals to have custodial services and cleaning of the buildings.

Mr. Ruseau - I would like to make a statement. The reason we spend the money we make at Before and After School and MEEP on programs that are not those programs is because that is how we fund Special Education, Adjustment counselors. This extra revenue is not extra revenue, this revenue is plugging a hole because we do not get it anywhere else. I wanted to say that, thank you. Ms. McLaughlin - We should encourage community members to come to Committee

of the Whole meetings where we discuss budgeting because it is complicated. Those are all public meetings where we can all learn together. Motion to accept the report offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report on Free Cash Allocation - Dr. Peter Cushing - The intercom system will be updated for \$59,000. Two bathrooms at the high school will be renovated for \$100,000. \$61,000 will be used for a backup power generator in the Vocational wing at the high school. New shades will be installed in C building at Medford High School for \$32,500. \$100,000 will be used for updating computers and outfitting the new makerspace in the Medford High School library. We would like to thank the City of Medford, Medford City Council and the residents of Medford. Ms. Graham - How many more computers do we need to replace? Ms. Patterson - We are attempting to achieve a 20% replacement in the budget each year so that we do not need to do large purchases like this over and over again. Mr. Ruseau - Do we need another 3 or 4% every year or do we need another 30%? Somerville spends a lot more money than us on technology replacement every year and they do not have greater needs than us. If we could get more money, what could we do with it? If we were willing to ask for more, if we told people what we could get if we asked for more, maybe they could understand. Motion to accept report offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin, motion passes.

Motion to table Request to Present New Options for Agenda Formatting offered by Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion is tabled.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn read condolences for Lawrence Flynn, Elisa Tocco-Leonard, Elizabeth Kenney, and Gerard Edouard.

Motion to adjourn offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Graham, motion passes. Meeting adjourned at 9:23pm.